

Baptism is the seal for our salvation. As the early church teachings the sacrament(mystical mystery) of baptism is seen as a gate of salvation. Who ever believed in Christ , he/ she would get baptized as a necessary and mandatory act. In the holy scripture, baptism is written in many places and seen as mandatory. Why?

As we are a fallen creations, our body(flesh, spirit and soul) should be cleansed with the power of baptism even though we believe in christ as he is the son of God. Early apostolic church fathers repeatedly said that the goal of Christianity is not prayer, metania(bowing before God), taking Eucharist(yegeta erat), and etc but the acquisition of the holy spirit. Even though our deeds are necessary in Christianity they are just the means to the acquisition of holy ghost(goal).

"Prayer, fasting and vigil are not the essence of our Christian life they are only means. The true goal of our Christian life is the acquisition of the holy spirit." -St.Seraphim of Sarvo

Since this is the only bold idea we have to stick with, we don't have to see any Christian activities as a goal.

Okay, now if the goal is the acquisition of the holy ghost how do we do that? If some one just become a Christian and say "I don't wanna get baptized" what is the matter? Is baptism alone enough for the acquisition of the holy spirit? How does someone get baptized? Is it just an immersion into the water to symbolize the death and resurrection of Christ?

In the book of John 3:5, "Unless one is born of water and spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God." This verse deeply explains the necessity of baptism with a great clarity. The reason why I said deeply is, according to the early apostolic church after someone has accepted Jesus as the true God he/she will immediately get baptized and then immediately after the baptism chrismation follows. This baptism is proceeded with the trinitarian formula which is being baptised in the name of the father, the son and the holy spirit being fully immersed three times (not only once as in the most Protestant denominations) in the water symbolizing the trinity and the three day's of Christ's body in the tomb. This baptism is believed to cleanse the body of the person from ancestral sin (as in oriental Orthodox) and original sin (as in Catholics) and personal sins, make the person a new born as the body of Christ, and make the person a fully clean temple for God. Rather than these, baptism has nothing to do with a Christian life by itself, but with chrismation it seals the beginning of salvation by the grace of God. According to early church tradition baptism and Christian are not merely two separated sacraments but are two sacraments as one with inseparable relationship in which someone begins the journey of salvation. Chrismation means simply anointing with a chrism (holy oil). It is a sacrament (mystery) of early church through which the baptized person receives the gift of holy spirit. This anointing with oil is done with a prayer by the priest putting his hand on the baptized person so the holy spirit descends on him/her. The early Church evidence for chrismation (anointing with chrism or sealing with the Holy Spirit) as a distinct act following baptism, and essential to full Christian initiation is:

“After you have come up from the pool of the sacred waters, you were anointed with the holy chrism... This is the anointing by which we were made partakers of Christ, by receiving the Holy Spirit.”

St. Cyril of Jerusalem (4th century) In his Mystagogical Catecheses(Catechesis 21)

“Then, having come out of the font, we are thoroughly anointed with the blessed unction... in order to receive the Holy Spirit.”

Tertullian (c. 200 AD) – De Baptismo

“After this, the bishop shall lay his hand upon them, invoking the Holy Spirit... Then, pouring the consecrated oil into his hand, he shall lay his hand on the head of each and say: ‘I anoint you with holy oil in the name of Jesus Christ.’”

St. Hippolytus of Rome (c. 215 AD) – Apostolic Tradition

The Samaritans were baptized, but had not yet received the Holy Spirit, until the apostles laid hands on them.

Acts 8:14–17 (Scripture)

The early Church Fathers saw this as the biblical foundation for chrismation, a second act following baptism, needed to receive the Holy Spirit. So according to their teaching, there is no such thing as baptism-alone as in Protestantism(they only acknowledged Eucharist(yegeta erat) and baptism but still with a distorted understanding and teaching). These sacraments are the basis for the beginning of a Christian life for whoever believe in christ should obey them. So simply You can think of baptism as cleansing and rebirth, and

chrismation as the breath of divine life entering the newborn. Baptism prepares the “vessel,” but chrismation fills it with the Holy Spirit.

Who is the baptiser?

Baptism is not merely a symbol, it is a sacrament. So it must be done by the right faith(Orthodox belief) , by the right intention and by the right authority(apostolic priesthood). This is not something which came later after the great schism(the separation of eastern Orthodox and rome Catholic church), it has a biblical basis. As philip the evangelist, the authority to baptise for missionary work was given by the apostles. But in some cases like emergency baptism(only baptism not with chrismation) can be done by an ordinary Christian.

Finally Baptism is followed by Eucharist, exorcism and etc activities

What is sacrament?

In the Orthodox Church (Coptic Orthodox), the Seven Sacraments (also called Mysteries) are divine channels through which God's grace is given to the faithful. They are not merely symbols but real, grace-filled acts instituted by Christ and practiced by the Apostolic Church.

1. Baptism:- Cleansing from sin and rebirth into the life of Christ. Removes ancestral (original) and personal sins, unites the person with the death and resurrection of Christ.

2. Chrismation (Confirmation):-Anointing with the Holy

Chrism (holy oil) immediately after baptism. Gives the gift of the Holy Spirit, completes Christian initiation.

Biblical Reference: Acts 8:14–17, 1 John 2:20, 2 Corinthians 1:21–22.

3. Eucharist (Holy Communion / Yegeta Erat):-Receiving the true Body and Blood of Jesus Christ under the form of bread and wine. Unites us with Christ and each other, gives spiritual nourishment and life.

Biblical Reference: John 6:53–56, 1 Corinthians 11:23–26, Matthew 26:26–28.

4. Confession (Penance or Reconciliation):-Confessing sins before a priest and receiving absolution. Restores the grace lost by sin, reconciles the person with God and the Church.

Biblical Reference: John 20:22–23, James 5:16, Proverbs 28:13.

5,Matrimony (Holy Marriage):- Sacramental union between a man and a woman. Blesses the couple to live in unity, love, and be co-workers with God in creation (children).

Biblical Reference: Ephesians 5:31–32, Matthew 19:5–6, Genesis 2:24.

6. Priesthood (Holy Orders):-Ordination into the sacramental ministry of the Church (bishop, priest, deacon). Grants the grace and authority to perform sacraments and guide the faithful.

Biblical Reference: 1 Timothy 4:14, Acts 6:6, Titus 1:5.

7. Unction of the Sick (Holy Anointing): Anointing with oil for physical and spiritual healing. Offers healing, forgiveness of sins, and comfort in suffering.

Biblical Reference: James 5:14–15, Mark 6:13.

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